

***Molecular mimicry between HLA-DR alleles
associated with rheumatoid arthritis and Proteus
mirabilis as the Aetiological basis for autoimmunity.***

Molecular mimicry is one of the pathological mechanisms proposed to explain the association between microorganisms and autoimmune diseases. This review deals with the association between bacteria and rheumatic diseases with a special emphasis on rheumatoid arthritis where upper urinary tract infection by *Proteus mirabilis* is the possible cause of this severe, arthritic condition. Prospective trials involving anti-*Proteus* therapy should be carried out.